

Interview Scoring Rubric

Anchored 1–5 scale. Write anchors before interviewing anyone; score answers against anchors, not against other candidates.

The universal anchor scale

Score	Anchor	What it looks like in an answer
1	No evidence	Vague, generic, or evasive. Cannot name specifics when probed twice.
2	Weak	Real example, but the candidate's own role is unclear or minimal ('we did...' with no 'I').
3	Solid	Specific example, clear personal actions, plausible outcome. The baseline for a hire-quality answer.
4	Strong	Specific and personally owned, plus reflection — can articulate what they'd do differently.
5	Exceptional	All of 4, plus evidence the behavior is repeated and deliberate, not a one-off survival story.

Worked example — 'Tell me about delivering bad news to a stakeholder'

Score	Anchored description
1	No specific example, or example shows avoidance (delayed, delegated, or softened the message into meaninglessness).
3	Specific example; delivered the news directly; can describe the stakeholder's reaction and their own follow-up.
5	All of 3, plus prepared the stakeholder in advance or brought options, and can articulate what they'd change — a deliberate approach, not a survived incident.

Writing rules for your own anchors

- Anchor 1, 3, and 5. Leave 2 and 4 as between-states — full anchoring adds work, not reliability.
- Use content criteria, not delivery criteria. 'Named the tradeoff explicitly' beats 'confident tone'.
- Test anchors on real answers: two scorers more than one point apart means the anchor is ambiguous — rewrite it.
- If every candidate scores 4+, the anchors are too soft. Recalibrate.

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